

Bluetooth support. The soundbar also supports 4K passthrough at 120Hz, making it an excellent choice for gamers who want to enjoy high-resolution graphics without compromising on audio quality. However, it's worth noting that the soundbar has only one HDMI input, which might be a limitation for users with multiple devices.

The inclusion of Bluetooth and Wi-Fi connectivity allows for seamless streaming from your favourite devices. The soundbar also supports voice assistants like Google Assistant and Amazon Alexa, making it easy to control with just your voice. The integration with Sony's Music Center app further enhances the user experience, providing additional customisation options and firmware updates.

User Experience

Setting up the Bravia Theatre Bar 9 is a breeze, thanks to the user-friendly interface and clear instructions. The soundbar can be easily integrated with a Sony Bravia TV, allowing you to use the TV's remote for seamless control. The Sony Music Center app further enhances the user experience by providing additional customisation options and firmware updates.

One minor gripe we had was the high latency via HDMI, which could be noticeable during gaming sessions. While this might not be a deal-breaker for most users, it's something to keep in mind if you're a competitive gamer. The soundbar's performance in terms of latency was otherwise satisfactory, with minimal delay during regular TV viewing and movie playback.

The remote control is well-designed and intuitive, with all the necessary buttons easily accessible. The on-screen display is clear and informative, making it easy to adjust settings and switch between different modes. The soundbar also comes with a wall-mounting kit, providing flexibility in terms of placement.

Additional Features

The Bravia Theatre Bar 9 comes with



several additional features that enhance its overall appeal. One such feature is the Night Mode, which reduces the intensity of loud sounds while enhancing dialogue clarity. This is particularly useful for late-night viewing when you don't want to disturb others in the household.

The soundbar also includes a Voice Enhancement feature, which boosts dialogue levels to make conversations more intelligible. This is a great addition for those who struggle to hear dialogue clearly, especially in movies with heavy sound effects and background music.

Another noteworthy feature is the Sound Field Optimization, which uses built-in microphones to analyse the room's acoustics and adjust the soundbar's settings accordingly. This ensures that you get the best possible audio experience, regardless of the room's size and layout.

Comparison with Competitors

When compared to other soundbars in its price range, the Bravia Theatre Bar 9 holds its own quite well. Its build quality, design, and feature set make it a strong contender in the premium soundbar market. However, the lack of

a dedicated subwoofer might be a drawback for some users, especially those who prioritise deep bass.

Competitors like the Sonos Arc and the Bose Smart Soundbar 900 offer similar features and performance, but each has its own strengths and weaknesses. The Sonos Arc, for instance, excels in terms of multi-room audio capabilities and seamless integration with other Sonos products. On the other hand, the Bose Smart Soundbar 900 offers a more refined design and slightly better bass performance.

Ultimately, the choice between these soundbars will come down to personal preference and specific needs. If you're looking for a soundbar that offers a balanced mix of features, performance, and design, the Bravia Theatre Bar 9 is definitely worth considering.

Verdict

The Sony Bravia Theatre Bar 9 is a solid choice for anyone looking to upgrade their home entertainment setup. Its sleek design, impressive sound quality, and advanced features make it a worthy contender in the premium soundbar market. While it may not offer the same level of bass as a system with a dedicated subwoofer, its overall performance and ease of use make it a compelling option.

If you're ready to invest in a soundbar that delivers a cinematic experience in your living room, the Bravia Theatre Bar 9 is definitely worth considering. Its combination of design, features, and sound quality make it a standout product in its category. Whether you're watching movies, playing games, or listening to music, this soundbar is sure to enhance your overall experience.

It is a testament to Sony's commitment to innovation and quality. It offers a premium audio experience that is sure to impress even the most discerning audiophiles. While it may have a few minor drawbacks, its strengths far outweigh its weaknesses. If you're in the market for a high-end soundbar, the Bravia Theatre Bar 9 should definitely be on your shortlist. **4**